ACT 1
Scene 1
INT : Athen's Club Emerald
NARRATOR
ACT 1, Scene 1
Enter Theseus, Hippolyta, and Philostrate, with others.
NARRATOR
Enter Theseus, Hippolyta, and Philostrate, with others.
THESEUS Now, fair Hippolyta, our nuptial hour Draws on apace. Four happy days bring in Another moor
HIPPOLYTA
Four days will quickly steep themselves in night; Four nights will quickly dream away the time; And ther
THESEUS
Go, Philostrate, Stir up the Athenian youth to merriments. Awake the pert and nimble spirit of mirth. T
Enter Egeus and his daughter Hermia, and Lysander and Demetrius.
NARRATOR
Enter Egeus and his daughter Hermia, and Lysander and Demetrius.
EGEUS
Happy be Theseus, our renownèd duke!
THESEUS
Thanks, good Egeus. What's the news with thee?
EGEUS
Full of vexation come I, with complaint Against my child, my daughter Hermia.— Stand forth, Demetrius
THESEUS
What say you, Hermia? Be advised, fair maid. To you, your father should be as a god, One that compose
HERMIA
So is Lysander.
THESEUS
In himself he is, But in this kind, wanting your father's voice, The other must be held the worthier.
HERMIA
I would my father looked but with my eyes.
THESEUS
Rather your eyes must with his judgment look.
HERMIA
I do entreat your Grace to pardon me. I know not by what power I am made bold, Nor how it may conc
THESEUS
Either to die the death, or to abjure Forever the society of men. Therefore, fair Hermia, question your d
HERMIA
So will I grow, so live, so die, my lord, Ere I will yield my virgin patent up Unto his lordship whose unwisl
THESEUS
Take time to pause, and by the next new moon (The sealing day betwixt my love and me For everlasting
DEMETRIUS
Relent, sweet Hermia, and, Lysander, yield Thy crazèd title to my certain right.
LYSANDER
You have her father's love, Demetrius. Let me have Hermia's. Do you marry him.
EGEUS
Scornful Lysander, true, he hath my love; And what is mine my love shall render him. And she is mine, a
LYSANDER,To Theseus

I am, my lord, as well derived as he, As well possessed. My love is more than his; My fortunes every wa
THESEUS
I must confess that I have heard so much, And with Demetrius thought to have spoke thereof; But, bein
EGEUS
With duty and desire we follow you.
All but Hermia and Lysanderexit.
NARRATOR
All but Hermia and Lysanderexit.
LYSANDER
How now, my love? Why is your cheek so pale? How chance the roses there do fade so fast?
HERMIA
Belike for want of rain, which I could well Beteem them from the tempest of my eyes.
LYSANDER
Ay me! For aught that I could ever read, Could ever hear by tale or history, The course of true love neve
HERMIA
O cross! Too high to be enthralled to low.
LYSANDER
Or else misgraffèd in respect of years—
HERMIA
O spite! Too old to be engaged to young.
LYSANDER
Or else it stood upon the choice of friends—
HERMIA
O hell, to choose love by another's eyes!
LYSANDER
Or, if there were a sympathy in choice, War, death, or sickness did lay siege to it, Making it momentany
HERMIA
If then true lovers have been ever crossed, It stands as an edict in destiny. Then let us teach our trial pa
LYSANDER
A good persuasion. Therefore, hear me, Hermia: I have a widow aunt, a dowager Of great revenue, and
HERMIA
My good Lysander, I swear to thee by Cupid's strongest bow, By his best arrow with the golden head, B
LYSANDER
Keep promise, love. Look, here comes Helena.
Enter Helena.
NARRATOR
Enter Helena.
HERMIA
Godspeed, fair Helena. Whither away?
HELENA
Call you me "fair"? That "fair" again unsay. Demetrius loves your fair. O happy fair! Your eyes are lodest
HERMIA
I frown upon him, yet he loves me still.
HELENA
O, that your frowns would teach my smiles such skill!
HERMIA
I give him curses, yet he gives me love.

HELENA
O, that my prayers could such affection move!
HERMIA
The more I hate, the more he follows me.
HELENA
The more I love, the more he hateth me.
HERMIA
His folly, Helena, is no fault of mine.
HELENA
None but your beauty. Would that fault were mine!
HERMIA
Take comfort: he no more shall see my face. Lysander and myself will fly this place. Before the time I di
LYSANDER
Helen, to you our minds we will unfold. Tomorrow night when Phoebe doth behold Her silver visage in t
HERMIA
And in the wood where often you and I Upon faint primrose beds were wont to lie, Emptying our boson
LYSANDER
I will, my Hermia.
Hermia exits.
NARRATOR
Hermia exits.
LYSANDER
Helena, adieu. As you on him, Demetrius dote on you!
Lysander exits.
NARRATOR
Hermia exits.
HELENA
How happy some o’er other some can be! Through Athens I am thought as fair as she. But what of that?
She exits.
NARRATOR
She exits.
ACT 1
Scene 2
INT : MicroBean Tea House
NARRATOR
Act 1 Scene 2
Enter Quince the carpenter, and Snug the joiner, and Bottom the weaver, and Flute the bellows-mende
NARRATOR
Enter Quince the carpenter, and Snug the joiner, and Bottom the weaver, and Flute the bellows-mende
QUINCE
Is all our company here?
BOTTOM
You were best to call them generally, man by man, according to the scrip.
QUINCE
Here is the scroll of every man’s name which is thought fit, through all Athens, to play in our interlude b
BOTTOM
First, good Peter Quince, say what the play treats on, then read the names of the actors, and so grow to

QUINCE
Marry, our play is “The most lamentable comedy and most cruel death of Pyramus and Thisbe.”
BOTTOM
A very good piece of work, I assure you, and a merry. Now, good Peter Quince, call forth your actors by
QUINCE
Answer as I call you. Nick Bottom, the weaver.
BOTTOM
Ready. Name what part I am for, and proceed.
QUINCE
You, Nick Bottom, are set down for Pyramus.
BOTTOM
What is Pyramus—a lover or a tyrant?
QUINCE
A lover that kills himself most gallant for love.
BOTTOM
That will ask some tears in the true performing of it. If I do it, let the audience look to their eyes. I will m
QUINCE
Francis Flute, the bellows-mender.
FLUTE
Here, Peter Quince.
QUINCE
Flute, you must take Thisbe on you.
FLUTE
What is Thisbe—a wand’ring knight?
QUINCE
It is the lady that Pyramus must love.
FLUTE
Nay, faith, let not me play a woman. I have a beard coming.
QUINCE
That’s all one. You shall play it in a mask, and you may speak as small as you will.
BOTTOM
An I may hide my face, let me play Thisbe too. I’ll speak in a monstrous little voice: “Thisne, Thisne!”—“
QUINCE
No, no, you must play Pyramus—and, Flute, you Thisbe.
BOTTOM
Well, proceed.
QUINCE
Robin Starveling, the tailor.
STARVELING
Here, Peter Quince.
QUINCE
Robin Starveling, you must play Thisbe’s mother.—Tom Snout, the tinker.
SNOUT
Here, Peter Quince.
QUINCE
You, Pyramus’ father.—Myself, Thisbe’s father.—Snug the joiner, you the lion’s part.— And I hope here
SNUG

Have you the lion’s part written? Pray you, if it be, give it me, for I am slow of study.
QUINCE
You may do it extempore, for it is nothing but roaring.
BOTTOM
Let me play the lion too. I will roar that I will do any man’s heart good to hear me. I will roar that I will n
QUINCE
An you should do it too terribly, you would fright the Duchess and the ladies that they would shriek, and
ALL
That would hang us, every mother’s son.
BOTTOM
I grant you, friends, if you should fright the ladies out of their wits, they would have no more discretion
QUINCE
You can play no part but Pyramus, for Pyramus is a sweet-faced man, a proper man as one shall see in a
BOTTOM
Well, I will undertake it. What beard were I best to play it in?
QUINCE
Why, what you will.
BOTTOM
I will discharge it in either your straw-color beard, your orange-tawny beard, your purple-in-grain beard
QUINCE
Some of your French crowns have no hair at all, and then you will play barefaced. But, masters, here are
BOTTOM
We will meet, and there we may rehearse most obscenely and courageously. Take pains. Be perfit. Adie
QUINCE
At the Duke’s Oak we meet.
BOTTOM
Enough. Hold, or cut bowstrings.
They exit.
NARRATOR
They exit.
ACT 2
Scene 1
INT : Forest Party : Entrance Gate, Swing
NARRATOR
Act 2, Scene 1
Enter a Fairy at one door and Robin Goodfellow at another.
NARRATOR
Enter a Fairy at one door and Robin Goodfellow at another.
ROBIN
How now, spirit? Whither wander you?
FAIRY
Over hill, over dale, Thorough bush, thorough brier, Over park, over pale, Thorough flood, thorough fire
ROBIN
The King doth keep his revels here tonight. Take heed the Queen come not within his sight, For Oberon
FAIRY
Either I mistake your shape and making quite, Or else you are that shrewd and knavish sprite Called Rob
ROBIN

Thou speakest aright. I am that merry wanderer of the night. I jest to Oberon and make him smile Wher
FAIRY
And here my mistress. Would that he were gone!
Enter Oberon the King of Fairies at one door, with his train, and Titania the Queen at another, with hers
NARRATOR
Enter Oberon the King of Fairies at one door, with his train, and Titania the Queen at another, with hers
OBERON
Ill met by moonlight, proud Titania.
TITANIA
What, jealous Oberon? Fairies, skip hence. I have forsworn his bed and company.
OBERON
Tarry, rash wanton. Am not I thy lord?
TITANIA
Then I must be thy lady. But I know When thou hast stolen away from Fairyland And in the shape of Cor
OBERON
How canst thou thus for shame, Titania, Glance at my credit with Hippolyta, Knowing I know thy love to
TITANIA
These are the forgeries of jealousy; And never, since the middle summer's spring, Met we on hill, in dal
OBERON
Do you amend it, then. It lies in you. Why should Titania cross her Oberon? I do but beg a little changeli
TITANIA
Set your heart at rest: The Fairyland buys not the child of me. His mother was a vot'ress of my order, Ar
OBERON
How long within this wood intend you stay?
TITANIA
Perchance till after Theseus' wedding day. If you will patiently dance in our round And see our moonligh
OBERON
Give me that boy and I will go with thee.
TITANIA
Not for thy fairy kingdom. Fairies, away. We shall chide downright if I longer stay.
Titania and her fairies exit.
NARRATOR
Titania and her fairies exit.
OBERON
Well, go thy way. Thou shalt not from this grove Till I torment thee for this injury.— My gentle Puck, co
ROBIN
I remember.
OBERON
That very time I saw (but thou couldst not), Flying between the cold moon and the earth, Cupid all arme
ROBIN
I'll put a girdle round about the Earth In forty minutes.
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
OBERON
Having once this juice, I'll watch Titania when she is asleep And drop the liquor of it in her eyes. The ne
Enter Demetrius, Helena following him.

NARRATOR
Enter Demetrius, Helena following him.
DEMETRIUS
I love thee not; therefore pursue me not. Where is Lysander and fair Hermia? The one I'll stay; the othe
HELENA
You draw me, you hard-hearted adamant! But yet you draw not iron, for my heart Is true as steel. Leave
DEMETRIUS
Do I entice you? Do I speak you fair? Or rather do I not in plainest truth Tell you I do not, nor I cannot lo
HELENA
And even for that do I love you the more. I am your spaniel, and, Demetrius, The more you beat me I wi
DEMETRIUS
Tempt not too much the hatred of my spirit, For I am sick when I do look on thee.
HELENA
And I am sick when I look not on you.
DEMETRIUS
You do impeach your modesty too much To leave the city and commit yourself Into the hands of one th
HELENA
Your virtue is my privilege. For that It is not night when I do see your face, Therefore I think I am not in t
DEMETRIUS
I'll run from thee and hide me in the brakes And leave thee to the mercy of wild beasts.
HELENA
The wildest hath not such a heart as you. Run when you will. The story shall be changed: Apollo flies an
DEMETRIUS
I will not stay thy questions. Let me go, Or if thou follow me, do not believe But I shall do thee mischief
HELENA
Ay, in the temple, in the town, the field, You do me mischief. Fie, Demetrius! Your wrongs do set a scan
NARRATOR
Demetrius exits.
HELENA
I'll follow thee and make a heaven of hell To die upon the hand I love so well.
Helena exits.
NARRATOR
Helena exits.
OBERON
Fare thee well, nymph. Ere he do leave this grove, Thou shalt fly him, and he shall seek thy love.
Enter Robin.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin.
OBERON
Hast thou the flower there? Welcome, wanderer.
ROBIN
Ay, there it is.
OBERON
I pray thee give it me.
Robin gives him the flower.
NARRATOR
Robin gives him the flower.

OBERON
I know a bank where the wild thyme blows, Where oxlips and the nodding violet grows, Quite overcano
He gives Robin part of the flower.
NARRATOR
He gives Robin part of the flower.
OBERON
A sweet Athenian lady is in love With a disdainful youth. Anoint his eyes, But do it when the next thing h
ROBIN
Fear not, my lord. Your servant shall do so.
They exit.
NARRATOR
They exit.
ACT 2
Scene 2
EXT : Forest Party :
NARRATOR
Act 2, Scene 2
Enter Titania, Queen of Fairies, with her train.
NARRATOR
Enter Titania, Queen of Fairies, with her train.
TITANIA
Come, now a roundel and a fairy song; Then, for the third part of a minute, hence— Some to kill canker
She lies down.
NARRATOR
She lies down.
Fairies sing.
NARRATOR
Fairies sing.
FIRST FAIRY
You spotted snakes with double tongue, Thorny hedgehogs, be not seen. Newts and blindworms, do no
CHORUS
Philomel, with melody Sing in our sweet lullaby. Lulla, lulla, lullaby, lulla, lulla, lullaby. Never harm Nor s
FIRST FAIRY
Weaving spiders, come not here. Hence, you long-legged spinners, hence. Beetles black, approach not r
CHORUS
Philomel, with melody Sing in our sweet lullaby. Lulla, lulla, lullaby, lulla, lulla, lullaby. Never harm Nor s
Titania sleeps.
NARRATOR
Titania sleeps.
SECOND FAIRY
Hence, away! Now all is well. One aloof stand sentinel.
Fairies exit.
NARRATOR
Fairies exit.
Enter Oberon, who anoints Titania’s eyelids with the nectar.
NARRATOR
Enter Oberon, who anoints Titania’s eyelids with the nectar.

Fairies exit. Enter Oberon, who anoints Titania’s eyelids with the nectar.
NARRATOR
Fairies exit. Enter Oberon, who anoints Titania’s eyelids with the nectar.
OBERON
What thou seest when thou dost wake, Do it for thy true love take. Love and languish for his sake. Be it
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
Enter Lysander and Hermia.
NARRATOR
Enter Lysander and Hermia.
LYSANDER
Fair love, you faint with wand’ring in the wood. And, to speak troth, I have forgot our way. We’ll rest us
HERMIA
Be it so, Lysander. Find you out a bed, For I upon this bank will rest my head.
LYSANDER
One turf shall serve as pillow for us both; One heart, one bed, two bosoms, and one troth.
HERMIA
Nay, good Lysander. For my sake, my dear, Lie further off yet. Do not lie so near.
LYSANDER
O, take the sense, sweet, of my innocence! Love takes the meaning in love’s conference. I mean that m
HERMIA
Lysander riddles very prettily. Now much beshrew my manners and my pride If Hermia meant to say Ly
LYSANDER
“Amen, amen” to that fair prayer, say I, And then end life when I end loyalty! Here is my bed. Sleep give
HERMIA
With half that wish the wisher’s eyes be pressed!
They sleep.
NARRATOR
They sleep.
Enter Robin.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin.
ROBIN
Through the forest have I gone, But Athenian found I none On whose eyes I might approve This flower’s
He sees Lysander.
NARRATOR
He sees Lysander.
ROBIN
Night and silence! Who is here? Weeds of Athens he doth wear. This is he my master said Despisèd the
He anoints Lysander’s eyelids with the nectar.
NARRATOR
He anoints Lysander’s eyelids with the nectar.
ROBIN
When thou wak’st, let love forbid Sleep his seat on thy eyelid. So, awake when I am gone, For I must no
He exits.
NARRATOR

He exits.
Enter Demetrius and Helena, running.
NARRATOR
Enter Demetrius and Helena, running.
HELENA
Stay, though thou kill me, sweet Demetrius.
DEMETRIUS
I charge thee, hence, and do not haunt me thus.
HELENA
O, wilt thou darkling leave me? Do not so.
DEMETRIUS
Stay, on thy peril. I alone will go.
Demetrius exits.
NARRATOR
Demetrius exits.
HELENA
O, I am out of breath in this fond chase. The more my prayer, the lesser is my grace. Happy is Hermia, w
Lysander, waking up
NARRATOR
Lysander, waking up
LYSANDER
And run through fire I will for thy sweet sake. Transparent Helena! Nature shows art, That through thy b
HELENA
Do not say so. Lysander, say not so. What though he love your Hermia? Lord, what though? Yet Hermia
LYSANDER
Content with Hermia? No, I do repent The tedious minutes I with her have spent. Not Hermia, but Helei
HELENA
Wherefore was I to this keen mockery born? When at your hands did I deserve this scorn? Is ’t not enou
She exits.
NARRATOR
She exits.
LYSANDER
She sees not Hermia.—Hermia, sleep thou there, And never mayst thou come Lysander near. For, as a s
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
Hermia Waking Up
NARRATOR
Hermia Waking Up
HERMIA
Help me, Lysander, help me! Do thy best To pluck this crawling serpent from my breast. Ay me, for pity
She exits.
NARRATOR
She exits.
ACT 3
Scene 1
INT : Forest Party Wide Angle

NARRATOR
Act 3, Scene 1
With Titania still asleep onstage, enter the Clowns, Bottom, Quince, Snout, Starveling, Snug, and Flute.
NARRATOR
With Titania still asleep onstage, enter the Clowns, Bottom, Quince, Snout, Starveling, Snug, and Flute.
BOTTOM
Are we all met?
QUINCE
Pat, pat. And here's a marvels convenient place for our rehearsal. This green plot shall be our stage, this
BOTTOM
Peter Quince?
QUINCE
What sayest thou, bully Bottom?
BOTTOM
There are things in this comedy of Pyramus and Thisbe that will never please. First, Pyramus must draw
SNOUT
By 'r lakin, a parlous fear.
STARVELING
I believe we must leave the killing out, when all is done.
BOTTOM
Not a whit! I have a device to make all well. Write me a prologue, and let the prologue seem to say we
QUINCE
Well, we will have such a prologue, and it shall be written in eight and six.
BOTTOM
No, make it two more. Let it be written in eight and eight.
SNOUT
Will not the ladies be afeard of the lion?
STARVELING
I fear it, I promise you.
BOTTOM
Masters, you ought to consider with yourself, to bring in (God shield us!) a lion among ladies is a most c
SNOUT
Therefore another prologue must tell he is not a lion.
BOTTOM
Nay, you must name his name, and half his face must be seen through the lion's neck, and he himself m
QUINCE
Well, it shall be so. But there is two hard things: that is, to bring the moonlight into a chamber, for you l
SNOUT
Doth the moon shine that night we play our play?
BOTTOM
A calendar, a calendar! Look in the almanac. Find out moonshine, find out moonshine. Quince takes out
NARRATOR
Quince takes out a book.
QUINCE
Yes, it doth shine that night.
BOTTOM
Why, then, may you leave a casement of the great chamber window, where we play, open, and the mo

QUINCE
Ay, or else one must come in with a bush of thorns and a lantern and say he comes to disfigure or to pr
SNOUT
You can never bring in a wall. What say you, Bottom?
BOTTOM
Some man or other must present Wall. And let him have some plaster, or some loam, or some roughca
QUINCE
If that may be, then all is well. Come, sit down, every mother's son, and rehearse your parts. Pyramus,
Enter Robin invisible to those onstage.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin invisible to those onstage.
Robin Speaks Aside
NARRATOR
Robin Speaks Aside
ROBIN
What hempen homespuns have we swagg'ring here So near the cradle of the Fairy Queen? What, a pla
QUINCE
Speak, Pyramus.—Thisbe, stand forth.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Thisbe, the flowers of odious savors sweet—
QUINCE
Odors, odors!
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
…odors savors sweet. So hath thy breath, my dearest Thisbe dear.— But hark, a voice! Stay thou but he
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
Robin Speaks Aside
NARRATOR
Robin Speaks Aside
ROBIN
A stranger Pyramus than e'er played here.
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
FLUTE
Must I speak now?
QUINCE
Ay, marry, must you, for you must understand he goes but to see a noise that he heard and is to come a
FLUTE, as Thisbe
Most radiant Pyramus, most lily-white of hue, Of color like the red rose on triumphant brier, Most brisk
QUINCE
"Ninus' tomb," man! Why, you must not speak that yet. That you answer to Pyramus. You speak all you
FLUTE, as Thisbe
O! As true as truest horse, that yet would never tire.
Enter Robin, and Bottom as Pyramus with the ass-head.
NARRATOR

Enter Robin, and Bottom as Pyramus with the ass-head.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
If I were fair, fair Thisbe, I were only thine.
QUINCE
O monstrous! O strange! We are haunted. Pray, masters, fly, masters! Help!
Quince, Flute, Snout, Snug, and Starveling exit.
NARRATOR
Quince, Flute, Snout, Snug, and Starveling exit.
ROBIN
I'll follow you. I'll lead you about a round, Through bog, through bush, through brake, through brier. Sor
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
BOTTOM
Why do they run away? This is a knavery of them to make me afeard.
Enter Snout.
NARRATOR
Enter Snout.
SNOUT
O Bottom, thou art changed! What do I see on thee?
BOTTOM
What do you see? You see an ass-head of your own, do you?
Snout exits.
NARRATOR
Snout exits.
Enter Quince.
NARRATOR
Enter Quince.
QUINCE
Bless thee, Bottom, bless thee! Thou art translated!
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
BOTTOM
I see their knavery. This is to make an ass of me, to fright me, if they could. But I will not stir from this p
TITANIA, waking up
What angel wakes me from my flow'ry bed?
BOTTOM
The finch, the sparrow, and the lark, The plainsong cuckoo gray, Whose note full many a man doth marl
TITANIA
I pray thee, gentle mortal, sing again. Mine ear is much enamored of thy note, So is mine eye enthrallèc
BOTTOM
Methinks, mistress, you should have little reason for that. And yet, to say the truth, reason and love kee
TITANIA
Thou art as wise as thou art beautiful.
BOTTOM
Not so neither; but if I had wit enough to get out of this wood, I have enough to serve mine own turn.

TITANIA
Out of this wood do not desire to go. Thou shalt remain here whether thou wilt or no. I am a spirit of nc
Enter four Fairies: Peaseblossom, Cobweb,
NARRATOR
Enter four Fairies: Peaseblossom, Cobweb,
Mote, and Mustardseed.
NARRATOR
Mote, and Mustardseed.
PEASEBLOSSOM
Ready.
COBWEB
And I.
MOTE
And I.
MUSTARDSEED
And I.
ALL
Where shall we go?
TITANIA
Be kind and courteous to this gentleman. Hop in his walks and gambol in his eyes; Feed him with aprico
PEASEBLOSSOM
Hail, mortal!
COBWEB
Hail!
MOTE
Hail!
MUSTARDSEED
Hail!
Bottom Points to Cobweb
NARRATOR
Bottom Points to Cobweb
BOTTOM
I cry your Worships mercy, heartily.—I beseech your Worship's name.
COBWEB
Cobweb.
BOTTOM
I shall desire you of more acquaintance, good Master Cobweb. If I cut my finger, I shall make bold with y
PEASEBLOSSOM
Peaseblossom.
Bottom Points to Peaseblossom
NARRATOR
Bottom Points to Peaseblossom
BOTTOM
I pray you, commend me to Mistress Squash, your mother, and to Master Peascod, your father. Good M
Bottom Points to Mustardseed
NARRATOR
Bottom Points to Mustardseed

MUSTARDSEED
Mustardseed.
BOTTOM
Good Master Mustardseed, I know your patience
well. That same cowardly, giantlike ox-beef hath devoured many a gentleman of your house. I promise
TITANIA
Come, wait upon him. Lead him to my bower. The moon, methinks, looks with a wat'ry eye, And when
They exit.
NARRATOR
They exit.
ACT 3
Scene 2
EXT : Forest Party : RainDance
NARRATOR
Act 3, Scene 2
Enter Oberon, King of Fairies.
NARRATOR
Enter Oberon, King of Fairies.
OBERON
I wonder if Titania be awaked; Then what it was that next came in her eye, Which she must dote on in
Enter Robin Goodfellow.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin Goodfellow.
OBERON
Here comes my messenger. How now, mad spirit? What night-rule now about this haunted grove?
ROBIN
My mistress with a monster is in love. Near to her close and consecrated bower, While she was in her d
OBERON
This falls out better than I could devise. But hast thou yet latched the Athenian's eyes With the love juic
ROBIN
I took him sleeping—that is finished, too— And the Athenian woman by his side, That, when he waked,
Enter Demetrius and Hermia.
NARRATOR
Enter Demetrius and Hermia.
OBERON
Stand close. This is the same Athenian.
ROBIN
This is the woman, but not this the man.
They step aside.
NARRATOR
They step aside.
DEMETRIUS
O, why rebuke you him that loves you so? Lay breath so bitter on your bitter foe!
HERMIA
Now I but chide, but I should use thee worse, For thou, I fear, hast given me cause to curse. If thou hast
DEMETRIUS
So should the murdered look, and so should I, Pierced through the heart with your stern cruelty. Yet yo

HERMIA
What's this to my Lysander? Where is he? Ah, good Demetrius, wilt thou give him me?
DEMETRIUS
I had rather give his carcass to my hounds.
HERMIA
Out, dog! Out, cur! Thou driv'st me past the bounds Of maiden's patience. Hast thou slain him, then? H
DEMETRIUS
You spend your passion on a misprised mood. I am not guilty of Lysander's blood, Nor is he dead, for au
HERMIA
I pray thee, tell me then that he is well.
DEMETRIUS
An if I could, what should I get therefor?
HERMIA
A privilege never to see me more. And from thy hated presence part I so. See me no more, whether he
She exits.
NARRATOR
She exits.
DEMETRIUS
There is no following her in this fierce vein. Here, therefore, for a while I will remain. So sorrow's heavir
He lies down and falls asleep.
NARRATOR
He lies down and falls asleep.
OBERON, to Robin
What hast thou done? Thou hast mistaken quite And laid the love juice on some true-love's sight. Of th
ROBIN
Then fate o'errules, that, one man holding troth, A million fail, confounding oath on oath.
OBERON
About the wood go swifter than the wind, And Helena of Athens look thou find. All fancy-sick she is and
ROBIN
I go, I go, look how I go, Swifter than arrow from the Tartar's bow.
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
Oberon, applying the nectar to Demetrius' eyes
NARRATOR
Oberon, applying the nectar to Demetrius' eyes
OBERON
Flower of this purple dye, Hit with Cupid's archery, Sink in apple of his eye. When his love he doth espy,
Enter Robin.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin.
ROBIN
Captain of our fairy band, Helena is here at hand, And the youth, mistook by me, Pleading for a lover's f
OBERON
Stand aside. The noise they make Will cause Demetrius to awake.
ROBIN
Then will two at once woo one. That must needs be sport alone. And those things do best please me Th

They step aside.
NARRATOR
They step aside.
Enter Lysander and Helena.
NARRATOR
Enter Lysander and Helena.
LYSANDER
Why should you think that I should woo in scorn? Scorn and derision never come in tears. Look when I v
HELENA
You do advance your cunning more and more. When truth kills truth, O devilish holy fray! These vows a
LYSANDER
I had no judgment when to her I swore.
HELENA
Nor none, in my mind, now you give her o'er.
LYSANDER
Demetrius loves her, and he loves not you.
DEMETRIUS, waking up
O Helen, goddess, nymph, perfect, divine! To what, my love, shall I compare thine eyne? Crystal is mud
HELENA
O spite! O hell! I see you all are bent To set against me for your merriment. If you were civil and knew c
LYSANDER
You are unkind, Demetrius. Be not so, For you love Hermia; this you know I know. And here with all goo
HELENA
Never did mockers waste more idle breath.
DEMETRIUS
Lysander, keep thy Hermia. I will none. If e'er I loved her, all that love is gone. My heart to her but as gu
LYSANDER
Helen, it is not so.
DEMETRIUS
Disparage not the faith thou dost not know, Lest to thy peril thou aby it dear. Look where thy love come
Enter Hermia.
NARRATOR
Enter Hermia.
HERMIA, to Lysander
Dark night, that from the eye his function takes, The ear more quick of apprehension makes; Wherein it
LYSANDER
Why should he stay whom love doth press to go?
HERMIA
What love could press Lysander from my side?
LYSANDER
Lysander's love, that would not let him bide, Fair Helena, who more engilds the night Than all yon fiery
HERMIA
You speak not as you think. It cannot be.
HELENA
Lo, she is one of this confederacy! Now I perceive they have conjoined all three To fashion this false spo
HERMIA
I am amazèd at your words. I scorn you not. It seems that you scorn me.

HELENA
Have you not set Lysander, as in scorn, To follow me and praise my eyes and face, And made your othe
HERMIA
I understand not what you mean by this.
HELENA
Ay, do. Persever, counterfeit sad looks, Make mouths upon me when I turn my back, Wink each at othe
LYSANDER
Stay, gentle Helena. Hear my excuse, My love, my life, my soul, fair Helena.
HELENA
O excellent!
HERMIA, to Lysander
Sweet, do not scorn her so.
DEMETRIUS, to Lysander
If she cannot entreat, I can compel.
LYSANDER
Thou canst compel no more than she entreat. Thy threats have no more strength than her weak prayer
DEMETRIUS
I say I love thee more than he can do.
LYSANDER
If thou say so, withdraw and prove it too.
DEMETRIUS
Quick, come.
HERMIALysander, whereto tends all this?
She takes hold of Lysander.
NARRATOR
She takes hold of Lysander.
LYSANDER
Away, you Ethiop!
DEMETRIUS, to Hermia
No, no. He'll Seem to break loose. To Lysander. Take on as you would follow, But yet come not. You are
LYSANDER, to Hermia
Hang off, thou cat, thou burr! Vile thing, let loose, Or I will shake thee from me like a serpent.
HERMIA
Why are you grown so rude? What change is this, Sweet love?
LYSANDER
Thy love? Out, tawny Tartar, out! Out, loathèd med'cine! O, hated potion, hence!
HERMIA
Do you not jest?
HELENA
Yes, sooth, and so do you.
LYSANDER
Demetrius, I will keep my word with thee.
DEMETRIUS
I would I had your bond. For I perceive A weak bond holds you. I'll not trust your word.
LYSANDER
What? Should I hurt her, strike her, kill her dead? Although I hate her, I'll not harm her so.
HERMIA

What, can you do me greater harm than hate? Hate me? Wherefore? O me, what news, my love? Am n
LYSANDER
Ay, by my life, And never did desire to see thee more. Therefore be out of hope, of question, of doubt. I
NARRATOR
Hermia turns him loose.
HERMIA
O me! To Helena. You juggler, you cankerblossom, You thief of love! What, have you come by night Anc
HELENA
Fine, i' faith. Have you no modesty, no maiden shame, No touch of bashfulness? What, will you tear Imp
HERMIA
"Puppet"? Why so? Ay, that way goes the game. Now I perceive that she hath made compare Between
HELENA
I pray you, though you mock me, gentlemen, Let her not hurt me. I was never curst; I have no gift at all
HERMIA
"Lower"? Hark, again!
HELENA
Good Hermia, do not be so bitter with me. I evermore did love you, Hermia, Did ever keep your counse
HERMIA
Why, get you gone. Who is 't that hinders you?
HELENA
A foolish heart that I leave here behind.
HERMIA
What, with Lysander?
HELENA
With Demetrius.
LYSANDER
Be not afraid. She shall not harm thee, Helena.
DEMETRIUS
No, sir, she shall not, though you take her part.
HELENA
O, when she is angry, she is keen and shrewd. She was a vixen when she went to school, And though sh
HERMIA
"Little" again? Nothing but "low" and "little"? Why will you suffer her to flout me thus? Let me come to
LYSANDER
Get you gone, you dwarf, You minimus of hind'ring knotgrass made, You bead, you acorn—
DEMETRIUS
You are too officious In her behalf that scorns your services. Let her alone. Speak not of Helena. Take nc
LYSANDER
Now she holds me not. Now follow, if thou dar'st, to try whose right, Of thine or mine, is most in Helena
DEMETRIUS
"Follow"? Nay, I'll go with thee, cheek by jowl. Demetrius and Lysander exit.
HERMIA
You, mistress, all this coil is long of you. Helena retreats. Nay, go not back.
HELENA
I will not trust you, I, Nor longer stay in your curst company. Your hands than mine are quicker for a fray
She exits.
NARRATOR

She exits.
HERMIA
I am amazed and know not what to say.
She exits.
NARRATOR
She exits.
OBERON, to Robin
This is thy negligence. Still thou mistak'st, Or else committ'st thy knaveries willfully.
ROBIN
Believe me, king of shadows, I mistook. Did not you tell me I should know the man By the Athenian garr
OBERON
Thou seest these lovers seek a place to fight. Hie, therefore, Robin, overcast the night; The starry welkir
He gives a flower to Robin.
NARRATOR
He gives a flower to Robin.
OBERON
Whose liquor hath this virtuous property, To take from thence all error with his might And make his eye
ROBIN
My fairy lord, this must be done with haste, For night's swift dragons cut the clouds full fast, And yonde
OBERON
But we are spirits of another sort. I with the Morning's love have oft made sport And, like a forester, the
NARRATOR
He exits.
ROBIN
Up and down, up and down, I will lead them up and down. I am feared in field and town. Goblin, lead th
NARRATOR
Enter Lysander.
LYSANDER
Where art thou, proud Demetrius? Speak thou now.
ROBIN, in Demetrius' voice
Here, villain, drawn and ready. Where art thou?
LYSANDER
I will be with thee straight.
ROBIN, in Demetrius' voice
Follow me, then, to plainer ground.
Lysander exits.
NARRATOR
Lysander exits.
Enter Demetrius.
NARRATOR
Enter Demetrius.
DEMETRIUSLysander, speak again.
Thou runaway, thou coward, art thou fled? Speak! In some bush? Where dost thou hide thy head?
ROBIN, in Lysander's voice
Thou coward, art thou bragging to the stars, Telling the bushes that thou look'st for wars, And wilt not c
DEMETRIUS
Yea, art thou there?

ROBIN, in Lysander’s voice
Follow my voice. We’ll try no manhood here.
They exit.
NARRATOR
They exit.
Enter Lysander.
NARRATOR
Enter Lysander.
LYSANDER
He goes before me and still dares me on. When I come where he calls, then he is gone. The villain is mu
He lies down and sleeps.
NARRATOR
He lies down and sleeps.
Enter Robin and Demetrius.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin and Demetrius.
ROBIN, in Lysander’s voice
Ho, ho, ho! Coward, why com’st thou not?
DEMETRIUS
Abide me, if thou dar’st, for well I wot Thou runn’st before me, shifting every place, And dar’st not stan
ROBIN, in Lysander’s voice
Come hither. I am here.
DEMETRIUS
Nay, then, thou mock’st me. Thou shalt buy this dear If ever I thy face by daylight see. Now go thy way.
He lies down and sleeps.
NARRATOR
He lies down and sleeps.
Enter Helena.
NARRATOR
Enter Helena.
HELENA
O weary night, O long and tedious night, Abate thy hours! Shine, comforts, from the east, That I may ba
She lies down and sleeps.
NARRATOR
She lies down and sleeps.
ROBIN
Yet but three? Come one more. Two of both kinds makes up four. Here she comes, curst and sad. Cupid
Enter Hermia.
NARRATOR
Enter Hermia.
HERMIA
Never so weary, never so in woe, Bedabbled with the dew and torn with briers, I can no further crawl, r
She lies down and sleeps.
NARRATOR
She lies down and sleeps.
ROBIN
On the ground Sleep sound. I’ll apply To your eye, Gentle lover, remedy.

Robin applies the nectar to Lysander’s eyes.
NARRATOR
Robin applies the nectar to Lysander’s eyes.
ROBIN
When thou wak’st, Thou tak’st True delight In the sight Of thy former lady’s eye. And the country prove
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
ACT 4
Scene 1
Forest Party : Fire Dancing
NARRATOR
Act 4, Scene 1
With the four lovers still asleep onstage, enter and Oberon, the King, behind them unseen by those ons
NARRATOR
With the four lovers still asleep onstage, enter and Oberon, the King, behind them unseen by those ons
TITANIA
Come, sit thee down upon this flow’ry bed, While I thy amiable cheeks do coy, And stick muskroses in tl
BOTTOM
Where’s Peaseblossom?
PEASEBLOSSOM
Ready.
BOTTOM
Scratch my head, Peaseblossom. Where’s Monsieur Cobweb?
COBWEB
Ready.
BOTTOM
Monsieur Cobweb, good monsieur, get you your weapons in your hand and kill me a red-hipped humble
Cobweb exits.
NARRATOR
Cobweb exits.
BOTTOM
Where’s Monsieur Mustardseed?
MUSTARDSEED
Ready.
BOTTOM
Give me your neaf, Monsieur Mustardseed. Pray you, leave your courtesy, good monsieur.
MUSTARDSEED
What’s your will?
BOTTOM
Nothing, good monsieur, but to help Cavalery Cobweb to scratch. I must to the barber’s, monsieur, for
TITANIA
What, wilt thou hear some music, my sweet love?
BOTTOM
I have a reasonable good ear in music. Let’s have the tongs and the bones.
TITANIA
Or say, sweet love, what thou desirest to eat.

BOTTOM
Truly, a peck of provender. I could munch your good dry oats. Methinks I have a great desire to a bottle
TITANIA
I have a venturous fairy that shall seek The squirrel’s hoard and fetch thee new nuts.
BOTTOM
I had rather have a handful or two of dried peas. But, I pray you, let none of your people stir me; I have
TITANIA
Sleep thou, and I will wind thee in my arms.— Fairies, begone, and be all ways away.
Fairies exit.
NARRATOR
Fairies exit.
TITANIA
So doth the woodbine the sweet honeysuckle Gently entwist; the female ivy so Enrings the barky finger
Bottom and Titania sleep.
NARRATOR
Bottom and Titania sleep.
Enter Robin Goodfellow.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin Goodfellow.
OBERON
Welcome, good Robin. Seest thou this sweet sight? Her dotage now I do begin to pity. For, meeting her
He applies the nectar to her eyes.
NARRATOR
He applies the nectar to her eyes.
OBERON
Be as thou wast wont to be. See as thou wast wont to see. Dian’s bud o’er Cupid’s flower Hath such for
TITANIA, waking
My Oberon, what visions have I seen! Methought I was enamored of an ass.
OBERON
There lies your love.
TITANIA
How came these things to pass? O, how mine eyes do loathe his visage now!
OBERON
Silence awhile.—Robin, take off this head.— Titania, music call; and strike more dead Than common sle
TITANIA
Music, ho, music such as charmeth sleep!
ROBIN, removing the ass-head from Bottom
Now, when thou wak’st, with thine own fool’s eyes peep.
OBERON
Sound music.
Music.
NARRATOR
Music.
OBERON
Come, my queen, take hands with me, And rock the ground whereon these sleepers be.
Titania and Oberon dance.
NARRATOR

Titania and Oberon dance.
OBERON
Now thou and I are new in amity, And will tomorrow midnight solemnly Dance in Duke Theseus' house
ROBIN
Fairy king, attend and mark. I do hear the morning lark.
OBERON
Then, my queen, in silence sad Trip we after night's shade. We the globe can compass soon, Swifter tha
TITANIA
Come, my lord, and in our flight Tell me how it came this night That I sleeping here was found With thes
Oberon, Robin, and Titania Exit
NARRATOR
Oberon, Robin, and Titania Exit
Wind horn. Enter Theseus and all his train,
NARRATOR
Wind horn. Enter Theseus and all his train,
Hippolyta, Egeus.
NARRATOR
Hippolyta, Egeus.
THESEUS
Go, one of you, find out the Forester. For now our observation is performed, And, since we have the va
A Servant exits.
NARRATOR
A Servant exits.
THESEUS
We will, fair queen, up to the mountain's top And mark the musical confusion Of hounds and echo in co
HIPPOLYTA
I was with Hercules and Cadmus once, When in a wood of Crete they bayed the bear With hounds of Sp
THESEUS
My hounds are bred out of the Spartan kind, So flewed, so sanded; and their heads are hung With ears
EGEUS
My lord, this is my daughter here asleep, And this Lysander; this Demetrius is, This Helena, old Nedar's
THESEUS
No doubt they rose up early to observe The rite of May, and hearing our intent, Came here in grace of c
EGEUS
It is, my lord.
THESEUS
Go, bid the huntsmen wake them with their horns.
A Servant exits.
NARRATOR
A Servant exits.
Shout within. Wind horns. They all start up.
NARRATOR
Shout within. Wind horns. They all start up.
THESEUS
Good morrow, friends. Saint Valentine is past. Begin these woodbirds but to couple now?
Demetrius, Helena, Hermia, and Lysander kneel.
NARRATOR

Demetrius, Helena, Hermia, and Lysander kneel.
LYSANDER
Pardon, my lord.
THESEUS
I pray you all, stand up.
They rise.
NARRATOR
They rise.
THESEUS
I know you two are rival enemies. How comes this gentle concord in the world, That hatred is so far fro
LYSANDER
My lord, I shall reply amazèdly, Half sleep, half waking. But as yet, I swear, I cannot truly say how I came
EGEUS
Enough, enough!—My lord, you have enough. I beg the law, the law upon his head. They would have st
DEMETRIUS
My lord, fair Helen told me of their stealth, Of this their purpose hither to this wood, And I in fury hithe
THESEUS
Fair lovers, you are fortunately met. Of this discourse we more will hear anon.— Egeus, I will overbear y
Theseus and his train, including Hippolyta and Egeus, exit.
NARRATOR
Theseus and his train, including Hippolyta and Egeus, exit.
DEMETRIUS
These things seem small and undistinguishable, Like far-off mountains turnèd into clouds.
HERMIA
Methinks I see these things with parted eye, When everything seems double.
HELENA
So methinks. And I have found Demetrius like a jewel, Mine own and not mine own.
DEMETRIUS
Are you sure That we are awake? It seems to me That yet we sleep, we dream. Do not you think The Du
HERMIA
Yea, and my father.
HELENA
And Hippolyta.
LYSANDER
And he did bid us follow to the temple.
DEMETRIUS
Why, then, we are awake. Let's follow him, And by the way let us recount our dreams.
Lovers exit.
NARRATOR
Lovers exit.
BOTTOM, waking up
When my cue comes, call me, and I will answer. My next is "Most fair Pyramus." Hey-ho! Peter Quince!
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
ACT 4
Scene 2

INT : MicroBean Tea House
NARRATOR
Act 4, Scene 2
Enter Quince, Flute, Snout, and Starveling.
NARRATOR
Enter Quince, Flute, Snout, and Starveling.
QUINCE
Have you sent to Bottom’s house? Is he come home yet?
STARVELING
He cannot be heard of. Out of doubt he is transported.
FLUTEIf he come not, then the play is marred. It goes
If he come not, then the play is marred. It goes not forward, doth it?
QUINCE
It is not possible. You have not a man in all Athens able to discharge Pyramus but he.
FLUTE
No, he hath simply the best wit of any handicraftman in Athens.
QUINCE
Yea, and the best person too, and he is a very paramour for a sweet voice.
FLUTE
You must say “paragon.” A “paramour” is (God bless us) a thing of naught.
Enter Snug the joiner.
NARRATOR
Enter Snug the joiner.
SNUG
Masters, the Duke is coming from the temple, and there is two or three lords and ladies more married.
FLUTE
O, sweet bully Bottom! Thus hath he lost six pence a day during his life. He could not have ’scaped six p
Enter Bottom.
NARRATOR
Enter Bottom.
BOTTOM
Where are these lads? Where are these hearts?
QUINCE
Bottom! O most courageous day! O most happy hour!
BOTTOM
Masters, I am to discourse wonders. But ask me not what; for, if I tell you, I am not true Athenian. I will
QUINCE
Let us hear, sweet Bottom.
BOTTOM
Not a word of me. All that I will tell you is that the Duke hath dined. Get your apparel together, good st
They exit.
ACT 5
Scene 1
EXT : Athen's Club
NARRATOR
Act 5, Scene 1
Enter Theseus, Hippolyta, and Philostrate, Lords, and Attendants.

NARRATOR
Enter Theseus, Hippolyta, and Philostrate, Lords, and Attendants.
HIPPOLYTA
’Tis strange, my Theseus, that these lovers speak of.
THESEUS
More strange than true. I never may believe These antique fables, nor these fairy toys. Lovers and madı
HIPPOLYTA
But all the story of the night told over, And all their minds transfigured so together, More witnesseth th
Enter Lovers: Lysander, Demetrius, Hermia, and Helena.
NARRATOR
Enter Lovers: Lysander, Demetrius, Hermia, and Helena.
THESEUS
Here come the lovers full of joy and mirth.— Joy, gentle friends! Joy and fresh days of love Accompany
LYSANDER
More than to us Wait in your royal walks, your board, your bed!
THESEUS
Come now, what masques, what dances shall we have To wear away this long age of three hours Betwe
PHILOSTRATE, coming forward
Here, mighty Theseus.
THESEUS
Say what abridgment have you for this evening, What masque, what music? How shall we beguile The l
PHILOSTRATE, giving Theseus a paper
There is a brief how many sports are ripe. Make choice of which your Highness will see first.
THESEUS
“The battle with the Centaurs, to be sung By an Athenian eunuch to the harp.” We’ll none of that. That
PHILOSTRATE
A play there is, my lord, some ten words long (Which is as brief as I have known a play), But by ten word
THESEUS
What are they that do play it?
PHILOSTRATE
Hard-handed men that work in Athens here, Which never labored in their minds till now, And now have
THESEUS
And we will hear it.
PHILOSTRATE
No, my noble lord, It is not for you. I have heard it over, And it is nothing, nothing in the world, Unless y
THESEUS
I will hear that play, For never anything can be amiss When simpleness and duty tender it. Go, bring the
Philostrate exits.
NARRATOR
Philostrate exits.
HIPPOLYTA
I love not to see wretchedness o’ercharged, And duty in his service perishing.
THESEUS
Why, gentle sweet, you shall see no such thing.
HIPPOLYTA
He says they can do nothing in this kind.
THESEUS

The kinder we, to give them thanks for nothing. Our sport shall be to take what they mistake; And what
Enter Philostrate.
NARRATOR
Enter Philostrate.
PHILOSTRATE
So please your Grace, the Prologue is addressed.
THESEUS
Let him approach.
Enter the Prologue.
NARRATOR
Enter the Prologue.
PROLOGUE
If we offend, it is with our goodwill. That you should think we come not to offend, But with goodwill. To
Prologue exits.
NARRATOR
Prologue exits.
THESEUS
This fellow doth not stand upon points.
LYSANDER
He hath rid his prologue like a rough colt; he knows not the stop. A good moral, my lord: it is not enoug
HIPPOLYTA
Indeed he hath played on this prologue like a child on a recorder—a sound, but not in government.
THESEUS
His speech was like a tangled chain—nothing impaired, but all disordered. Who is next? Enter Pyramus(
NARRATOR
Enter Pyramus(Bottom), and Thisbe(Flute), and Wall(Snout), and Moonshine(Starveling), and Lion (Snug
QUINCE, as Prologue
Gentles, perchance you wonder at this show. But wonder on, till truth make all things plain. This man is
THESEUS
I wonder if the lion be to speak.
DEMETRIUS
No wonder, my lord. One lion may when many asses do.
Lion, Thisbe, Moonshine, and Prologueexit.
NARRATOR
Lion, Thisbe, Moonshine, and Prologueexit.
SNOUT, as Wall
In this same interlude it doth befall That I, one Snout by name, present a wall; And such a wall as I woul
THESEUS
Would you desire lime and hair to speak better?
DEMETRIUS
It is the wittiest partition that ever I heard discourse, my lord.
THESEUS
Pyramus draws near the wall. Silence.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
O grim-looked night! O night with hue so black! O night, which ever art when day is not! O night! O nigh
THESEUS
The wall, methinks, being sensible, should curse again.

BOTTOM
No, in truth, sir, he should not. “Deceiving me” is Thisbe’s cue. She is to enter now, and I am to spy her
Enter Thisbe(Flute).
NARRATOR
Enter Thisbe(Flute).
FLUTE, as Thisbe
O wall, full often hast thou heard my moans For parting my fair Pyramus and me. My cherry lips have of
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
I see a voice! Now will I to the chink To spy an I can hear my Thisbe’s face. Thisbe?
FLUTE, as Thisbe
My love! Thou art my love, I think.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Think what thou wilt, I am thy lover’s grace, And, like Limander, am I trusty still.
FLUTE, as Thisbe
And I like Helen, till the Fates me kill.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Not Shafalus to Procrus was so true.
FLUTE, as Thisbe
As Shafalus to Procrus, I to you.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
O kiss me through the hole of this vile wall.
FLUTE, as Thisbe
I kiss the wall’s hole, not your lips at all.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Wilt thou at Ninny’s tomb meet me straightway?
FLUTE, as Thisbe
’Tide life, ’tide death, I come without delay.
Bottom and Flute exit.
NARRATOR
Bottom and Flute exit.
SNOUT, as Wall
Thus have I, Wall, my part dischargèd so, And, being done, thus Wall away doth go.
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.
THESEUS
Now is the wall down between the two neighbors.
DEMETRIUS
No remedy, my lord, when walls are so willful to hear without warning.
HIPPOLYTA
This is the silliest stuff that ever I heard.
THESEUS
The best in this kind are but shadows, and the worst are no worse, if imagination amend them.
HIPPOLYTA
It must be your imagination, then, and not
theirs.
THESEUS

If we imagine no worse of them than they of themselves, they may pass for excellent men. Here come t
Enter Lion(Snug) and Moonshine(Starveling).
NARRATOR
Enter Lion(Snug) and Moonshine(Starveling).
SNUG, as Lion
You ladies, you whose gentle hearts do fear The smallest monstrous mouse that creeps on floor, May n
THESEUS
A very gentle beast, and of a good conscience.
DEMETRIUS
The very best at a beast, my lord, that e'er I saw.
LYSANDER
This lion is a very fox for his valor.
THESEUS
True, and a goose for his discretion.
DEMETRIUS
Not so, my lord, for his valor cannot carry his discretion, and the fox carries the goose.
THESEUS
His discretion, I am sure, cannot carry his valor, for the goose carries not the fox. It is well. Leave it to hi
STARVELING, as Moonshine
This lanthorn doth the hornèd moon present.
DEMETRIUS
He should have worn the horns on his head.
THESEUS
He is no crescent, and his horns are invisible within the circumference.
STARVELING, as Moonshine
This lanthorn doth the hornèd moon present. Myself the man i' th' moon do seem to be.
THESEUS
This is the greatest error of all the rest; the man should be put into the lanthorn. How is it else "the mar
DEMETRIUS
He dares not come there for the candle, for you see, it is already in snuff.
HIPPOLYTA
I am aweary of this moon. Would he would change.
THESEUS
It appears by his small light of discretion that he is in the wane; but yet, in courtesy, in all reason, we mı
LYSANDER
Proceed, Moon.
STARVELING, as Moonshine
All that I have to say is to tell you that the lanthorn is the moon, I the man i' th' moon, this thornbush m
DEMETRIUS
Why, all these should be in the lanthorn, for all these are in the moon. But silence. Here comes Thisbe.
Enter Thisbe(Flute).
NARRATOR
Enter Thisbe(Flute).
FLUTE, as Thisbe
This is old Ninny's tomb. Where is my love?
SNUG, as Lion
O!

The Lion roars. Thisbe runs off, dropping her mantle.
NARRATOR
The Lion roars. Thisbe runs off, dropping her mantle.
DEMETRIUS
Well roared, Lion.
THESEUS
Well run, Thisbe.
HIPPOLYTA
Well shone, Moon. Truly, the Moon shines with a good grace.
Lion worries the mantle.
NARRATOR
Lion worries the mantle.
THESEUS
Well moused, Lion.
Enter Pyramus(Bottom).
NARRATOR
Enter Pyramus(Bottom).
DEMETRIUS
And then came Pyramus.
Lion exits.
NARRATOR
Lion exits.
LYSANDER
And so the lion vanished.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Sweet Moon, I thank thee for thy sunny beams. I thank thee, Moon, for shining now so bright, For by th
THESEUS
This passion, and the death of a dear friend, would go near to make a man look sad.
HIPPOLYTA
Beshrew my heart but I pity the man. O, wherefore, Nature, didst thou lions frame, Since lion vile hath l
Pyramus stabs himself.
NARRATOR
Pyramus stabs himself.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Thus die I, thus, thus, thus. Now am I dead; Now am I fled; My soul is in the sky. Tongue, lose thy light! I
Moonshine exits.
NARRATOR
Moonshine exits.
BOTTOM, as Pyramus
Now die, die, die, die, die.
Pyramus falls.
NARRATOR
Pyramus falls.
DEMETRIUS
No die, but an ace for him, for he is but one.
LYSANDER
Less than an ace, man, for he is dead, he is nothing.

THESEUS
With the help of a surgeon he might yet recover and yet prove an ass.
HIPPOLYTA
How chance Moonshine is gone before Thisbe comes back and finds her lover?
THESEUS
She will find him by starlight.
Enter Thisbe (Flute).
NARRATOR
Enter Thisbe (Flute).
Here she comes, and her passion ends the play.
HIPPOLYTA
Methinks she should not use a long one for such a Pyramus. I hope she will be brief.
DEMETRIUS
A mote will turn the balance, which Pyramus, which Thisbe, is the better: he for a man, God warrant us;
LYSANDER
She hath spied him already with those sweet eyes.
DEMETRIUS
And thus she means, videlicet—
FLUTE, as Thisbe
Asleep, my love? What, dead, my dove? O Pyramus, arise! Speak, speak. Quite dumb? Dead? Dead? A t
Thisbe stabs herself.
NARRATOR
Thisbe stabs herself.
FLUTE, as Thisbe
And farewell, friends. Thus Thisbe ends. Adieu, adieu, adieu.
Thisbe falls.
NARRATOR
Thisbe falls.
THESEUS
Moonshine and Lion are left to bury the dead.
DEMETRIUS
Ay, and Wall too.
Bottom and Flute arise.
NARRATOR
Bottom and Flute arise.
BOTTOM
No, I assure you, the wall is down that parted their fathers. Will it please you to see the Epilogue or to h
THESEUS
No epilogue, I pray you. For your play needs no excuse. Never excuse. For when the players are all dead
Dance, and the players exit.
NARRATOR
Dance, and the players exit.
THESEUS
The iron tongue of midnight hath told twelve. Lovers, to bed! 'Tis almost fairy time. I fear we shall outsl
They exit.
NARRATOR
They exit.

Enter Robin Goodfellow.
NARRATOR
Enter Robin Goodfellow.
ROBIN
Now the hungry lion roars, And the wolf behowls the moon, Whilst the heavy plowman snores, All with
Enter Oberon and Titania, King and Queen of Fairies, with all their train.
NARRATOR
Enter Oberon and Titania, King and Queen of Fairies, with all their train.
OBERON
Through the house give glimmering light, By the dead and drowsy fire. Every elf and fairy sprite, Hop as
TITANIA
First rehearse your song by rote, To each word a warbling note. Hand in hand, with fairy grace, Will we
Oberon leads the Fairies in song and dance.
NARRATOR
Oberon leads the Fairies in song and dance.
OBERON
Now, until the break of day, Through this house each fairy stray. To the best bride-bed will we, Which b
All but Robin exit.
NARRATOR
All but Robin exit.
ROBIN If we shadows have offended, Think but this and all is mended: That you have but slumbered he
He exits.
NARRATOR
He exits.

ı. But, O, methinks how slow This old moon wanes! She lingers my desires Like to a stepdame or a dowa

n the moon, like to a silver bow New -bent in heaven, shall behold the night Of our solemnities.

urn melancholy forth to funerals; The pale companion is not for our pomp. Philostrate exits. Hippolyta, I

s.—My noble lord, This man hath my consent to marry her.— Stand forth, Lysander.—And, my gracious

ed your beauties, yea, and one To whom you are but as a form in wax By him imprinted, and within his p

ern my modesty In such a presence here to plead my thoughts; But I beseech your Grace that I may kno

lesires, Know of your youth, examine well your blood, Whether (if you yield not to your father's choice)

g bond of fellowship), Upon that day either prepare to die For disobedience to your father's will, Or else

y as fairly ranked (If not with vantage) as Demetrius'; And (which is more than all these boasts can be) I a

ıg overfull of self-affairs, My mind did lose it.—But, Demetrius, come, And come, Egeus; you shall go wit

as a sound, Swift as a shadow, short as any dream, Brief as the lightning in the collied night, That, in a s

tience Because it is a customary cross, As due to love as thoughts and dreams and sighs, Wishes and tea

she hath no child. From Athens is her house remote seven leagues, And she respects me as her only son

y the simplicity of Venus' doves, By that which knitteth souls and prospers loves, And by that fire which

tars and your tongue's sweet air More tunable than lark to shepherd's ear When wheat is green, when h

d Lysander see Seemed Athens as a paradise to me. O, then, what graces in my love do dwell That he ha

the wat'ry glass, Decking with liquid pearl the bladed grass (A time that lovers' flights doth still conceal),

ns of their counsel sweet, There my Lysander and myself shall meet, And thence from Athens turn away

? Demetrius thinks not so. He will not know what all but he do know. And, as he errs, doting on Hermia's

ıove storms; I will condole in some measure. To the rest.—Yet my chief humor is for a tyrant. I could pla

but to hang us. But I will aggravate my voice so that I will roar you as gently as any sucking dove. I will r

e your parts, giving out the parts, and I am to entreat you, request you, and desire you to con them by t

; I do wander everywhere, Swifter than the moon's sphere. And I serve the Fairy Queen, To dew her orb

is passing fell and wrath Because that she, as her attendant, hath A lovely boy stolen from an Indian kin

oin Goodfellow. Are not you he That frights the maidens of the villagery, Skim milk, and sometimes labo

n I a fat and bean-fed horse beguile, Neighing in likeness of a filly foal. And sometime lurk I in a gossip's b

rin sat all day Playing on pipes of corn and versing love To amorous Phillida. Why art thou here, Come fro

Theseus? Didst not thou lead him through the glimmering night From Perigouna, whom he ravishèd, An

e, forest, or mead, By pavèd fountain or by rushy brook, Or in the beachèd margent of the sea, To dance

nd in the spicèd Indian air by night Full often hath she gossiped by my side And sat with me on Neptune's

me hither. Thou rememb'rest Since once I sat upon a promontory And heard a mermaid on a dolphin's b

ed. A certain aim he took At a fair vestal thronèd by the west, And loosed his love-shaft smartly from his

xt thing then she, waking, looks upon (Be it on lion, bear, or wolf, or bull, On meddling monkey, or on bu

r stayeth me. Thou told’st me they were stol’n unto this wood, And here am I, and wood within this wo

ill fawn on you. Use me but as your spaniel: spurn me, strike me, Neglect me, lose me; only give me leav

ıat loves you not, To trust the opportunity of night And the ill counsel of a desert place With the rich wo

the night. Nor doth this wood lack worlds of company, For you, in my respect, are all the world. Then, h

d Daphne holds the chase; The dove pursues the griffin; the mild hind Makes speed to catch the tiger. B

dal on my sex. We cannot fight for love as men may do. We should be wooed and were not made to wo

›pied with luscious woodbine, With sweet muskroses, and with eglantine. There sleeps Titania sometime

›e espies May be the lady. Thou shalt know the man By the Athenian garments he hath on. Effect it with

s in the muskrose buds, Some war with reremice for their leathern wings To make my small elves coats,

ounce, or cat, or bear, Pard, or boar with bristled hair, In thy eye that shall appear When thou wak’st, it

y heart unto yours is knit, So that but one heart we can make of it; Two bosoms interchainèd with an oa

sander lied. But, gentle friend, for love and courtesy, Lie further off in human modesty. Such separation,

Athenian maid. And here the maiden, sleeping sound On the dank and dirty ground. Pretty soul, she dui

/heresoe’er she lies, For she hath blessèd and attractive eyes. How came her eyes so bright? Not with sa

)osom makes me see thy heart. Where is Demetrius? O, how fit a word Is that vile name to perish on my

na I love. Who will not change a raven for a dove? The will of man is by his reason swayed, And reason s

ugh, is ’t not enough, young man, That I did never, no, nor never can Deserve a sweet look from Demetri

surfeit of the sweetest things The deepest loathing to the stomach brings, Or as the heresies that men d

! What a dream was here! Lysander, look how I do quake with fear. Methought a serpent ate my heart a

s hawthorn brake our tiring-house, and we will do it in action as we will do it before the Duke.

will do no harm with our swords, and that Pyramus is not killed indeed. And, for the more better assurar

dreadful thing. For there is not a more fearful wildfowl than your lion living, and we ought to look to 't.

ıust speak through, saying thus, or to the same defect: "Ladies," or "Fair ladies, I would wish you," or "I v

esent the person of Moonshine. Then there is another thing: we must have a wall in the great chamber,

st about him to signify wall, or let him hold his fingers thus, and through that cranny shall Pyramus and T

you begin. When you have spoken your speech, enter into that brake, and so everyone according to his c

y juvenal and eke most lovely Jew, As true as truest horse, that yet would never tire. I'll meet thee, Pyra

metime a horse I'll be, sometime a hound, A hog, a headless bear, sometime a fire, And neigh, and bark,

lace, do what they can. I will walk up and down here, and I will sing, that they shall hear I am not afraid.

k And dares not answer "nay"— for, indeed, who would set his wit to so foolish a bird? Who would give

d to thy shape, And thy fair virtue's force perforce doth move me On the first view to say, to swear, I lov

ep little company together nowadays. The more the pity that some honest neighbors will not make then

› common rate. The summer still doth tend upon my state, And I do love thee. Therefore go with me. I'll

cks and dewberries, With purple grapes, green figs, and mulberries; The honey-bags steal from the hum

Master Peaseblossom, I shall desire you of more acquaintance, too.—Your name, I beseech you, sir?

you, your kindred hath made my eyes water ere now. I desire you of more acquaintance, good Master M

she weeps, weeps every little flower, Lamenting some enforcèd chastity. Tie up my lover's tongue. Bring

ull and sleeping hour, A crew of patches, rude mechanicals, That work for bread upon Athenian stalls, W

: slain Lysander in his sleep, Being o'er shoes in blood, plunge in the deep And kill me too. The sun was n

enceforth be never numbered among men. O, once tell true! Tell true, even for my sake! Durst thou hav

ıess doth heavier grow For debt that bankrout sleep doth sorrow owe, Which now in some slight measu

pale of cheer With sighs of love that costs the fresh blood dear. By some illusion see thou bring her her

Let her shine as gloriously As the Venus of the sky.— When thou wak’st, if she be by, Beg of her for rem

vow, I weep; and vows so born, In their nativity all truth appears. How can these things in me seem scor

re Hermia's. Will you give her o'er? Weigh oath with oath, and you will nothing weigh. Your vows to her

dy. O, how ripe in show Thy lips, those kissing cherries, tempting grow! That pure congealèd white, high

ourtesy, You would not do me thus much injury. Can you not hate me, as I know you do, But you must j

odwill, with all my heart, In Hermia's love I yield you up my part. And yours of Helena to me bequeath, W

t doth impair the seeing sense, It pays the hearing double recompense. Thou art not by mine eye, Lysan

oes and eyes of light. Why seek'st thou me? Could not this make thee know The hate I bear thee made

ort in spite of me.— Injurious Hermia, most ungrateful maid, Have you conspired, have you with these c

r love, Demetrius, Who even but now did spurn me with his foot, To call me goddess, nymph, divine and

r, hold the sweet jest up. This sport, well carried, shall be chronicled. If you have any pity, grace, or man

s. — Helen, I love thee. By my life, I do. I swear by that which I will lose for thee, To prove him false that

ot I Hermia? Are not you Lysander? I am as fair now as I was erewhile. Since night you loved me; yet sin

Be certain, nothing truer, ’tis no jest That I do hate thee and love Helena. Hermia turns him loose.

our statures; she hath urged her height, And with her personage, her tall personage, Her height, forsoot

in shrewishness. I am a right maid for my cowardice. Let her not strike me. You perhaps may think, Beca

ls, never wronged you— Save that, in love unto Demetrius, I told him of your stealth unto this wood. He

ments he had on? And so far blameless proves my enterprise That I have ’nointed an Athenian’s eyes; Ar

n cover thou anon With drooping fog as black as Acheron, And lead these testy rivals so astray As one co

eballs roll with wonted sight. When they next wake, all this derision Shall seem a dream and fruitless visi

r shines Aurora’s harbinger, At whose approach, ghosts wand’ring here and there Troop home to church

e groves may tread Even till the eastern gate, all fiery red, Opening on Neptune with fair blessèd beams,

come? Come, recreant! Come, thou child! I’ll whip thee with a rod. He is defiled That draws a sword on t

ch lighter-heeled than I. I followed fast, but faster he did fly, That fallen am I in dark uneven way, And he

Faintness constraineth me To measure out my length on this cold bed. By day's approach look to be visi

ck to Athens by daylight From these that my poor company detest. And sleep, that sometimes shuts up

ıo further go. My legs can keep no pace with my desires. Here will I rest me till the break of day. Heaven

rb known, That every man should take his own, In your waking shall be shown. Jack shall have Jill; Naugl

e-bee on the top of a thistle, and, good monsieur, bring me the honey-bag. Do not fret yourself too muc

methinks I am marvels hairy about the face. And I am such a tender ass, if my hair do but tickle me, I mu

of late behind the wood, Seeking sweet favors for this hateful fool, I did upbraid her and fall out with he

triumphantly, And bless it to all fair prosperity. There shall the pairs of faithful lovers be Wedded, with T

ward of the day, My love shall hear the music of my hounds. Uncouple in the western valley; let them g

arta. Never did I hear Such gallant chiding, for, besides the groves, The skies, the fountains, every regior

that sweep away the morning dew; Crook-kneed, and dewlapped like Thessalian bulls; Slow in pursuit, b

our solemnity. But speak, Egeus. Is not this the day That Hermia should give answer of her choice?

e here. But, as I think—for truly would I speak, And now I do bethink me, so it is: I came with Hermia hith

ol'n away.—They would, Demetrius, Thereby to have defeated you and me: You of your wife and me of

r followed them, Fair Helena in fancy following me. But, my good lord, I wot not by what power (But by

your will, For in the temple by and by, with us, These couples shall eternally be knit.— And, for the morn

Flute the bellows-mender! Snout the tinker! Starveling! God's my life! Stolen hence and left me asleep!

ence a day. An the Duke had not given him six pence a day for playing Pyramus, I'll be hanged. He would

rings to your beards, new ribbons to your pumps. Meet presently at the palace. Every man look o'er his

men have such seething brains, Such shaping fantasies, that apprehend More than cool reason ever com

an fancy's images And grows to something of great constancy, But, howsoever, strange and admirable.

een our after-supper and bedtime? Where is our usual manager of mirth? What revels are in hand? Is th

have I told my love In glory of my kinsman Hercules. "The riot of the tipsy Bacchanals, Tearing the Thrac

ds, my lord, it is too long, Which makes it tedious; for in all the play, There is not one word apt, one play

ou can find sport in their intents, Extremely stretched and conned with cruel pain To do you service.

: poor duty cannot do, noble respect Takes it in might, not merit. Where I have come, great clerks have p

› show our simple skill, That is the true beginning of our end. Consider, then, we come but in despite. We

Bottom), and Thisbe(Flute), and Wall(Snout), and Moonshine(Starveling), and Lion (Snug), and Prologue

Pyramus, if you would know. This beauteous lady Thisbe is certain. This man with lime and roughcast do

d have you think That had in it a crannied hole or chink, Through which the lovers, Pyramus and Thisbe,

ıt! Alack, alack, alack! I fear my Thisbe's promise is forgot. And thou, O wall, O sweet, O lovely wall, That

ow perchance both quake and tremble here, When lion rough in wildest rage doth roar. m A lion fell, no

y gracious, golden, glittering gleams, I trust to take of truest Thisbe sight.— But stay! O spite! But mark,

here deflowered my dear, Which is—no, no—which was the fairest dame That lived, that loved, that like

omb Must cover thy sweet eyes. These lily lips, This cherry nose, These yellow cowslip cheeks Are gone,

l, there need none to be blamed. Marry, if he that writ it had played Pyramus and hanged himself in This

eep the coming morn As much as we this night have overwatched. This palpable-gross play hath well be

weary task fordone. Now the wasted brands do glow, Whilst the screech-owl, screeching loud, Puts the

y us shall blessèd be, And the issue there create Ever shall be fortunate. So shall all the couples three Ev

re While these visions did appear. And this weak and idle theme, No more yielding but a dream, Gentles

I wooed thee with my sword And won thy love doing thee injuries, But I will wed thee in another key, W

duke, This man hath bewitched the bosom of my child.— Thou, thou, Lysander, thou hast given her rhy

You can endure the livery of a nun, For aye to be in shady cloister mewed, To live a barren sister all you

to wed Demetrius, as he would, Or on Diana’s altar to protest For aye austerity and single life.

am beloved of beauteous Hermia. Why should not I then prosecute my right? Demetrius, I'll avouch it to

h me. I have some private schooling for you both.— For you, fair Hermia, look you arm yourself To fit yo

pleen, unfolds both heaven and earth, And, ere a man hath power to say "Behold!" The jaws of darkness

n. There, gentle Hermia, may I marry thee; And to that place the sharp Athenian law Cannot pursue us. If

burned the Carthage queen When the false Trojan under sail was seen, By all the vows that ever men ha

hawthorn buds appear. Sickness is catching. O, were favor so! Yours would I catch, fair Hermia, ere I go. I

our eyes To seek new friends and stranger companies. Farewell, sweet playfellow. Pray thou for us, And

s eyes, So I, admiring of his qualities. Things base and vile, holding no quantity, Love can transpose to for

ıy Ercles rarely, or a part to tear a cat in, to make all split: The raging rocks And shivering shocks Shall bre

ɔmorrow night and meet me in the palace wood, a mile without the town, by moonlight. There will we r

ɔs upon the green. The cowslips tall her pensioners be; In their gold coats spots you see; Those be rubies

g; She never had so sweet a changeling. And jealous Oberon would have the child Knight of his train, to

r in the quern And bootless make the breathless huswife churn, And sometime make the drink to bear n

bowl In very likeness of a roasted crab, And, when she drinks, against her lips I bob And on her withered

om the farthest steep of India, But that, forsooth, the bouncing Amazon, Your buskined mistress and you

e our ringlets to the whistling wind, But with thy brawls thou hast disturbed our sport. Therefore the win

s yellow sands, Marking th' embarkèd traders on the flood, When we have laughed to see the sails conc

back Uttering such dulcet and harmonious breath That the rude sea grew civil at her song And certain sta

bow As it should pierce a hundred thousand hearts. But I might see young Cupid's fiery shaft Quenched

sy ape) She shall pursue it with the soul of love. And ere I take this charm from off her sight (As I can tak

ve (Unworthy as I am) to follow you. What worser place can I beg in your love (And yet a place of high re

ɛ of the night, Lulled in these flowers with dances and delight. And there the snake throws her enamelec

ı some care, that he may prove More fond on her than she upon her love. And look thou meet me ere th

and some keep back The clamorous owl that nightly hoots and wonders At our quaint spirits. Sing me n

ıth— So then two bosoms and a single troth. Then by your side no bed-room me deny, For lying so, Herr

, as may well be said, Becomes a virtuous bachelor and a maid. So far be distant; and good night, sweet f

rst not lie Near this lack-love, this kill-courtesy.— Churl, upon thy eyes I throw All the power this charm c

ılt tears. If so, my eyes are oftener washed than hers. No, no, I am as ugly as a bear, For beasts that mee

ays you are the worthier maid. Things growing are not ripe until their season; So I, being young, till now

ius’ eye, But you must flout my insufficiency? Good troth, you do me wrong, good sooth, you do, In such

ɔ leave Are hated most of those they did deceive, So thou, my surfeit and my heresy, Of all be hated, bu

ıway, And you sat smiling at his cruel prey. Lysander! What, removed? Lysander, lord! What, out of hear

nce, tell them that I, Pyramus, am not Pyramus, but Bottom the weaver. This will put them out of fear.

would request you," or "I would entreat you not to fear, not to tremble! My life for yours. If you think I c

He sings.The ouzel cock, so black of hue, With orange-tawny bill, The throstle with his note so true, The

l give thee fairies to attend on thee, And they shall fetch thee jewels from the deep And sing while thou

ble-bees, And for night-tapers crop their waxen thighs And light them at the fiery glowworms' eyes To h

/ere met together to rehearse a play Intended for great Theseus' nuptial day. The shallowest thick-skin c

ot so true unto the day As he to me. Would he have stolen away From sleeping Hermia? I'll believe as sc

ve looked upon him, being awake? And hast thou killed him sleeping? O brave touch! Could not a worm,

Taurus’ snow, Fanned with the eastern wind, turns to a crow When thou hold’st up thy hand. O, let me

oin in souls to mock me too? If you were men, as men you are in show, You would not use a gentle lady

der, found; Mine ear, I thank it, brought me to thy sound. But why unkindly didst thou leave me so?

ontrived, To bait me with this foul derision? Is all the counsel that we two have shared, The sisters’ vows

l rare, Precious, celestial? Wherefore speaks he this To her he hates? And wherefore doth Lysander Den

ıners, You would not make me such an argument. But fare you well. 'Tis partly my own fault, Which deat

th, she hath prevailed with him. And are you grown so high in his esteem Because I am so dwarfish and s

followed you; for love, I followed him. But he hath chid me hence and threatened me To strike me, spu

ɔme not within another’s way. Like to Lysander sometime frame thy tongue; Then stir Demetrius up with

on. And back to Athens shall the lovers wend, With league whose date till death shall never end. Whiles

ɲyards. Damnèd spirits all, That in crossways and floods have burial, Already to their wormy beds are goı

Turns into yellow gold his salt-green streams. But notwithstanding, haste! Make no delay. We may effe

ere will rest me. Come, thou gentle day, For if but once thou show me thy gray light, I'll find Demetrius a

h in the action, monsieur, and, good monsieur, have a care the honey-bag break not; I would be loath tc

er. For she his hairy temples then had rounded With coronet of fresh and fragrant flowers; And that sam

ıut matched in mouth like bells, Each under each. A cry more tunable Was never holloed to, nor cheered

ıer. Our intent Was to be gone from Athens, where we might, Without the peril of the Athenian law—

some power it is) my love to Hermia, Melted as the snow, seems to me now As the remembrance of an

ıing now is something worn, Our purposed hunting shall be set aside. Away with us to Athens. Three anc

I have had a most rare vision. I have had a dream past the wit of man to say what dream it was. Man is

part. For the short and the long is, our play is preferred. In any case, let Thisbe have clean linen, and let

ıprehends. The lunatic, the lover, and the poet Are of imagination all compact. One sees more devils tha

ian singer in their rage." That is an old device, and it was played When I from Thebes came last a conque

er fitted. And tragical, my noble lord, it is. For Pyramus therein doth kill himself, Which, when I saw rehe

ɔurposèd To greet me with premeditated welcomes, Where I have seen them shiver and look pale, Mak

e do not come, as minding to content you, Our true intent is. All for your delight We are not here. That y

ɔth present “Wall,” that vile wall which did these lovers sunder; And through Wall’s chink, poor souls, th

Did whisper often, very secretly. This loam, this roughcast, and this stone doth show That I am that sam

: stand’st between her father’s ground and mine, Thou wall, O wall, O sweet and lovely wall, Show me th

›r else no lion’s dam; For if I should as lion come in strife Into this place, ’twere pity on my life.

poor knight, What dreadful dole is here! Eyes, do you see! How can it be! O dainty duck! O dear! Thy m

ed, that looked with cheer? Come, tears, confound! Out, sword, and wound The pap of Pyramus; Ay, tha

are gone! Lovers, make moan; His eyes were green as leeks. O Sisters Three, Come, come to me With h

sbe's garter, it would have been a fine tragedy; and so it is, truly, and very notably discharged. But, come

guiled The heavy gait of night. Sweet friends, to bed. A fortnight hold we this solemnity In nightly revels

wretch that lies in woe In remembrance of a shroud. Now it is the time of night That the graves, all gap

er true in loving be, And the blots of Nature’s hand Shall not in their issue stand. Never mole, harelip, nc

, do not reprehend. If you pardon, we will mend. And, as I am an honest Puck, If we have unearnèd luck

mes And interchanged love tokens with my child. Thou hast by moonlight at her window sung With feigr

r life, Chanting faint hymns to the cold fruitless moon. Thrice-blessèd they that master so their blood To

› his head, Made love to Nedar’s daughter, Helena, And won her soul; and she, sweet lady, dotes, Devou

›ur fancies to your father’s will, Or else the law of Athens yields you up (Which by no means we may exte

f thou lovest me, then Steal forth thy father’s house tomorrow night, And in the wood a league without

ave broke (In number more than ever women spoke), In that same place thou hast appointed me, Tomo

My ear should catch your voice, my eye your eye; My tongue should catch your tongue’s sweet melody.

d good luck grant thee thy Demetrius.— Keep word, Lysander. We must starve our sight From lovers' foo

m and dignity. Love looks not with the eyes but with the mind; And therefore is winged Cupid painted b

eak the locks Of prison gates. And Phibbus’ car Shall shine from far And make and mar The foolish Fates.

·ehearse, for if we meet in the city, we shall be dogged with company and our devices known. In the me·

;, fairy favors; In those freckles live their savors. I must go seek some dewdrops here And hang a pearl in

trace the forests wild. But she perforce withholds the lovèd boy, Crowns him with flowers, and makes h

o barm, Mislead night wanderers, laughing at their harm? Those that “Hobgoblin” call you, and “sweet I

dewlap pour the ale. The wisest aunt, telling the saddest tale, Sometime for three-foot stool mistaketh

ur warrior love, To Theseus must be wedded, and you come To give their bed joy and prosperity?

ıds, piping to us in vain, As in revenge have sucked up from the sea Contagious fogs, which, falling in the

eive And grow big-bellied with the wanton wind; Which she, with pretty and with swimming gait, Follow

in the chaste beams of the wat'ry moon, And the imperial vot'ress passèd on In maiden meditation, far

ce it with another herb), I'll make her render up her page to me. But who comes here? I am invisible, An

d skin, Weed wide enough to wrap a fairy in. And with the juice of this I'll streak her eyes And make her t

t me run away for fear. Therefore no marvel though Demetrius Do as a monster fly my presence thus. W

ripe not to reason. And touching now the point of human skill, Reason becomes the marshal to my will

disdainful manner me to woo. But fare you well. Perforce I must confess I thought you lord of more tru

t the most of me! And, all my powers, address your love and might To honor Helen and to be her knight

ing? Gone? No sound, no word? Alack, where are you? Speak, an if you hear. Speak, of all loves! I swoo

come hither as a lion, it were pity of my life. No, I am no such thing. I am a man as other men are." And t

on pressèd flowers dost sleep. And I will purge thy mortal grossness so That thou shalt like an airy spirit

ıave my love to bed and to arise; And pluck the wings from painted butterflies To fan the moonbeams fr

of that barren sort, Who Pyramus presented in their sport, Forsook his scene and entered in a brake. Wh

oon This whole Earth may be bored, and that the moon May through the center creep and so displease h

an adder, do so much? An adder did it, for with doubler tongue Than thine, thou serpent, never adder s

so, To vow and swear and superpraise my parts, When, I am sure, you hate me with your hearts. You bc

s, the hours that we have spent When we have chid the hasty-footed time For parting us—O, is all forgo

y your love (so rich within his soul) And tender me, forsooth, affection, But by your setting on, by your c

so low? How low am I, thou painted maypole? Speak! How low am I? I am not yet so low But that my na

ırn me, nay, to kill me too. And now, so you will let me quiet go, To Athens will I bear my folly back And t

ı bitter wrong. And sometime rail thou like Demetrius. And from each other look thou lead them thus, T

I in this affair do thee employ, I’ll to my queen and beg her Indian boy; And then I will her charmèd eye

ne. For fear lest day should look their shames upon, They willfully themselves exile from light And must

ıe dew, which sometime on the buds Was wont to swell like round and orient pearls, Stood now within t

l with horn, In Crete, in Sparta, nor in Thessaly. Judge when you hear.—But soft! What nymphs are these

idle gaud Which in my childhood I did dote upon, And all the faith, the virtue of my heart, The object an

but an ass if he go about to expound this dream. Methought I was—there is no man can tell what. Meth

not him that plays the lion pare his nails, for they shall hang out for the lion’s claws. And, most dear actc

ɜn vast hell can hold: That is the madman. The lover, all as frantic, Sees Helen’s beauty in a brow of Egyp

ɛror. “The thrice-three Muses mourning for the death Of learning, late deceased in beggary.” That is son

ɛarsed, I must confess, Made mine eyes water; but more merry tears The passion of loud laughter never

e periods in the midst of sentences, Throttle their practiced accent in their fears, And in conclusion dum

/ou should here repent you, The actors are at hand, and, by their show, You shall know all that you are li

ıey are content To whisper, at the which let no man wonder. This man, with lantern, dog, and bush of th

ıe wall. The truth is so. And this the cranny is, right and sinister, Through which the fearful lovers are to v

ıy chink to blink through with mine eyne. Thanks, courteous wall. Jove shield thee well for this. But what

antle good— What, stained with blood? Approach, ye Furies fell! O Fates, come, come, Cut thread and t

ands as pale as milk. Lay them in gore, Since you have shore With shears his thread of silk. Tongue, not a

ing wide, Every one lets forth his sprite In the church-way paths to glide. And we fairies, that do run By t

or scar, Nor mark prodigious, such as are Despisèd in nativity, Shall upon their children be. With this fielc

Now to ’scape the serpent’s tongue, We will make amends ere long. Else the Puck a liar call. So good nig

ıing voice verses of feigning love And stol’n the impression of her fantasy With bracelets of thy hair, ring

undergo such maiden pilgrimage, But earthlier happy is the rose distilled Than that which, withering on

enuate) To death or to a vow of single life.— Come, my Hippolyta. What cheer, my love?— Demetrius a

the town (Where I did meet thee once with Helena To do observance to a morn of May), There will I sta

Were the world mine, Demetrius being bated, The rest I'd give to be to you translated. O, teach me hov

blind. Nor hath Love’s mind of any judgment taste. Wings, and no eyes, figure unheedy haste. And theref

This was lofty. Now name the rest of the players. This is Ercles' vein, a tyrant's vein. A lover is more con

ı every cowslip’s ear. Farewell, thou lob of spirits. I’ll be gone. Our queen and all her elves come here an

im all her joy. And now they never meet in grove or green, By fountain clear, or spangled starlight sheen

me; Then slip I from her bum, down topples she, And “Tailor!” cries, and falls into a cough, And then the

land, Hath every pelting river made so proud That they have overborne their continents. The ox hath th

ving (her womb then rich with my young squire), Would imitate and sail upon the land To fetch me trifles

ıcy-free. Yet marked I where the bolt of Cupid fell. It fell upon a little western flower, Before, milk-white

What wicked and dissembling glass of mine Made me compare with Hermia’s sphery eyne? But who is he

n almost with fear.— No? Then I well perceive you are not nigh. Either death or you I’ll find immediately

ıen I did him at this advantage take, An ass's noll I fixèd on his head. Anon his Thisbe must be answerèd,

ɥer brother's noontide with th' Antipodes. It cannot be but thou hast murdered him. So should a murde

ɔth are rivals and love Hermia, And now both rivals to mock Helena. A trim exploit, a manly enterprise, T

t? All schooldays' friendship, childhood innocence? We, Hermia, like two artificial gods, Have with our n

onsent? What though I be not so in grace as you, So hung upon with love, so fortunate, But miserable m

ill o’er their brows death-counterfeiting sleep With leaden legs and batty wings doth creep. Then crush

:he pretty flouriets’ eyes, Like tears that did their own disgrace bewail. When I had at my pleasure taunt

ıd the pleasure of mine eye, Is only Helena. To her, my lord, Was I betrothed ere I saw Hermia. But like a

ıought I was and methought I had—but man is but a patched fool if he will offer to say what methought

ors, eat no onions nor garlic, for we are to utter sweet breath, and I do not doubt but to hear them say it

t. The poet’s eye, in a fine frenzy rolling, Doth glance from heaven to Earth, from Earth to heaven, And a

ne satire, keen and critical, Not sorting with a nuptial ceremony. “A tedious brief scene of young Pyramu

bly have broke off, Not paying me a welcome. Trust me, sweet, Out of this silence yet I picked a welcom

orn, Presenteth “Moonshine,” for, if you will know, By moonshine did these lovers think no scorn To me

t see I? No Thisbe do I see. O wicked wall, through whom I see no bliss, Cursed be thy stones for thus de

:he triple Hecate's team From the presence of the sun, Following darkness like a dream, Now are frolic. I

l-dew consecrate Every fairy take his gait, And each several chamber bless, Through this palace, with sw

gs, gauds, conceits, Knacks, trifles, nosegays, sweetmeats—messengers Of strong prevailment in unhard

nd Egeus, go along. I must employ you in some business Against our nuptial, and confer with you Of som

fore is Love said to be a child Because in choice he is so oft beguiled. As waggish boys in game themselve

ı, But they do square, that all their elves for fear Creep into acorn cups and hide them there.

e whole choir hold their hips and loffe And waxen in their mirth and neeze and swear A merrier hour wa

ıerefore stretched his yoke in vain, The plowman lost his sweat, and the green corn Hath rotted ere his y

s and return again, As from a voyage, rich with merchandise. But she, being mortal, of that boy did die, A

, now purple with love's wound, And maidens call it "love-in-idleness." Fetch me that flower; the herb I

ere? Lysander, on the ground! Dead or asleep? I see no blood, no wound.— Lysander, if you live, good si

And forth my mimic comes. When they him spy, As wild geese that the creeping fowler eye, Or russet-p

·o conjure tears up in a poor maid’s eyes With your derision! None of noble sort Would so offend a virgi

eedles created both one flower, Both on one sampler, sitting on one cushion, Both warbling of one song

ed her, And she in mild terms begged my patience, I then did ask of her her changeling child, Which stra

sickness did I loathe this food. But, as in health, come to my natural taste, Now I do wish it, love it, long

I had. The eye of man hath not heard, the ear of man hath not seen, man’s hand is not able to taste, his

ıs imagination bodies forth The forms of things unknown, the poet's pen Turns them to shapes and gives

ıs And his love Thisbe, very tragical mirth." "Merry" and "tragical"? "Tedious" and "brief"? That is hot ice

ıe, And in the modesty of fearful duty, I read as much as from the rattling tongue Of saucy and audaciou

ɛet at Ninus' tomb, there, there to woo. This grisly beast (which "Lion" hight by name) The trusty Thisbe

Not a mouse Shall disturb this hallowed house. I am sent with broom before, To sweep the dust behind t

eet peace. And the owner of it blest, Ever shall in safety rest. Trip away. Make no stay. Meet me all by b

ened youth. With cunning hast thou filched my daughter’s heart, Turned her obedience (which is due to

es forswear, So the boy Love is perjured everywhere. For, ere Demetrius looked on Hermia’s eyne, He ha

/outh attained a beard. The fold stands empty in the drownèd field, And crows are fatted with the murra

showed thee once. The juice of it on sleeping eyelids laid Will make or man or woman madly dote Upon

ɔated choughs, many in sort, Rising and cawing at the gun’s report, Sever themselves and madly sweep t

ş, both in one key, As if our hands, our sides, voices, and minds Had been incorporate. So we grew togetl

ight she gave me, and her fairy sent To bear him to my bower in Fairyland. And now I have the boy, I wil

s tongue to conceive, nor his heart to report what my dream was. I will get Peter Quince to write a ballac

s to airy nothing A local habitation and a name. Such tricks hath strong imagination That, if it would but

s eloquence. Love, therefore, and tongue-tied simplicity In least speak most, to my capacity.

coming first by night Did scare away, or rather did affright; And, as she fled, her mantle she did fall, Whi

me) To stubborn harshness.—And, my gracious duke, Be it so she will not here before your Grace Conse

ailed down oaths that he was only mine; And when this hail some heat from Hermia felt, So he dissolved

ain flock. The nine-men’s-morris is filled up with mud, And the quaint mazes in the wanton green, For la

the next live creature that it sees. Fetch me this herb, and be thou here again Ere the leviathan can swi

the sky, So at his sight away his fellows fly, And, at our stamp, here o’er and o’er one falls. He “Murder”

her Like to a double cherry, seeming parted, But yet an union in partition, Two lovely berries molded on

ll undo This hateful imperfection of her eyes. And, gentle Puck, take this transformèd scalp From off the

d of this dream. It shall be called “Bottom’s Dream” because it hath no bottom; and I will sing it in the la

apprehend some joy, It comprehends some bringer of that joy. Or in the night, imagining some fear, How

ich Lion vile with bloody mouth did stain. Anon comes Pyramus, sweet youth and tall, And finds his trust

ent to marry with Demetrius, I beg the ancient privilege of Athens: As she is mine, I may dispose of her, \

l, and show’rs of oaths did melt. I will go tell him of fair Hermia’s flight. Then to the wood will he tomorr

ck of tread, are undistinguishable. The human mortals want their winter here. No night is now with hym

cries and help from Athens calls. Their sense thus weak, lost with their fears thus strong, Made senseles

one stem; So with two seeming bodies but one heart, Two of the first, like coats in heraldry, Due but to

head of this Athenian swain, That he, awaking when the other do, May all to Athens back again repair A

tter end of a play, before the Duke. Peradventure, to make it the more gracious, I shall sing it at her dea

:y Thisbe’s mantle slain. Whereat, with blade, with bloody blameful blade, He bravely broached his boilir

Which shall be either to this gentleman Or to her death, according to our law Immediately provided in tł

n or carol blessed. Therefore the moon, the governess of floods, Pale in her anger, washes a

s things begin to do them wrong; For briers and thorns at their apparel snatch, Some sleeves,

hat case.